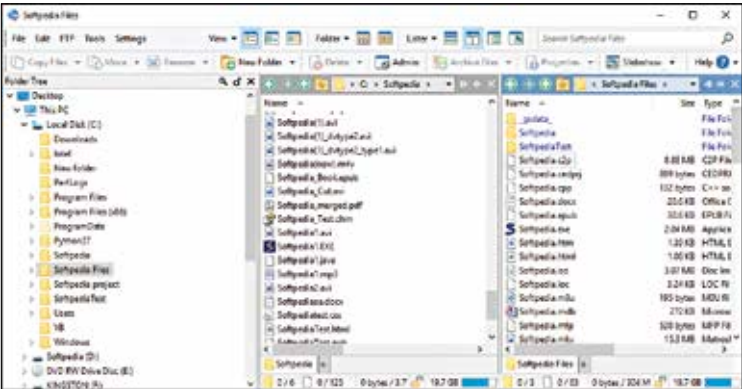


2. Directory Opus

Directory Opus, like Total Commander, is a premium file manager – and it shows. It features a more busy icon-led interface than Total Commander, but it can be toned down with the many customization options. This is where Directory Opus really shines, as nearly every aspect of its operation can be modified and tuned to meet your specific requirements.



No oops with this one

It's also quick, thanks to its multi-threading capabilities, which allow you to queue and handle activities. There are a number of useful features, like multi-pane opening and tabbed browsing, as well as the ability to easily filter and sort your files and folders.

Directory Opus is available in two versions: Light and Pro. Both make file management a breeze, but Pro is worth the extra money because it can replace File Explorer for everything or just select folders.

The Pro also functions as an FTP client and a file compression utility. It has a more customisable interface than its cheaper sibling, as well as integrated metadata editing and the ability to save complex search keywords as macros for future use. Both versions are available for a free 30-day trial.

3. Xplorer²

Xplorer² is a premium file manager that comes in two flavours: a basic Professional edition and a more capable Ultimate edition.

This one is the most modern-looking of all the file managers we've tried. You can choose between a ribbon-style interface and a more traditional menu bar.